Zhengchao Wang,

zhengchao.wang@sydney.edu.au | https://zhengchaowang.github.io

School of Business Analytics and Marketing, University of Sydney Business School

Employment

University of Sydney Business School 2026. 01 – Present
Lecturer (Assistant Professor)

Imperial College Business School 2025. 08 – 2026. 01
Research Associate

Education

Imperial College Business School 2020 – 2025
Ph.D. in Analytics and Operations

M.Res. in Analytics and Operations (*Distinction*) 2019 – 2020

École Polytechnique Fédéral de Lausanne 2015 – 2017
M.S. in Energy Management and Sustainability

Harbin Institute of Technology 2010 – 2014
B.Eng. in Civil Engineering

Exchange at Hanyang University, South Korea 2012 – 2013

Research

Refereed Journal Papers:

Randomized Assortment Optimization
Zhengchao Wang, Heikki Peura, and Wolfram Wiesemann
Operations Research, 2024

Working Papers:

Multi-Armed Bernoulli Bandits via Minimax Single-Arm Stopping
Huikang Liu, Zhengchao Wang, Daniel Kuhn, and Wolfram Wiesemann
arXiv:2609.22690, 2026

Overcoming Demand Censoring through Randomization for Risk-Sensitive Newsvendor Learning
Zhengchao Wang and Nam Ho-Nguyen
Under review

From Data to Donations: Optimal Fundraising Campaigns for Non-Profit Organizations
Zhengchao Wang, Heikki Peura, Sven Mikolon, and Wolfram Wiesemann
Manuscript available upon request

From Markov Chain Choice to Markov Decision Processes: Equivalence, Optimization, and Construction
Zhengchao Wang
Manuscript available upon request

Work in Progress:

Optimal Human-in-the-Loop Recommendation under Endogenous Trust and Probabilistic Adherence
Zhengchao Wang, Huikang Liu, and Huan Xu

Assortment Optimization with Endogenous Consideration and Discount Disclosure
Yi Chen, Jing Dong, Zhengchao Wang, and Fanyin Zheng

Online Assortment Optimization for Balanced and Diversified Demand
Zhengchao Wang, Hanzhao Wang, and Kalyan Talluri

Decision-Guided Variational Inference: Problem Classes, Distance Metrics, and Computation
Lingjun Meng and Zhengchao Wang

Other Publications:

Towards Realization of an Energy Internet: Designing Distributed Energy Systems using Game-theoretic Approach
A.T. Dasun Perera, Zhengchao Wang, Vahid Nik, and Jean-Louis Scartezzini
Applied Energy, 2021

Integrated Platform to Design Robust Energy Internet
Zhengchao Wang and A.T. Dasun Perera
Applied Energy, 2020

Understanding Pedestrian Behavior: From Data to Management Strategies
Michel Bierlaire, Riccardo Scarinci, Marija Nikolic, Yuki Oyama, Nicholas Molyneaux, and Zhengchao Wang
Routledge Handbook of Urban Mobility, June 2020

Conference Proceedings:

Robust Optimization of Power Grid with Distributed Generation and Improved Reliability
Zhengchao Wang and A.T. Dasun Perera
REM2018: Renewable Energy Integration with Mini/Microgrid (Invited for journal submission)

Integrated Optimization of Charging Stations for Electric Taxis
Zhengchao Wang, Yuki Oyama, Michel Bierlaire, and Nikolaos Geroliminis
19*th Swiss Transport Research Conference*

Pedestrian Activity Schedule Models: Review and Promises
Zhengchao Wang, Yuki Oyama, Riccardo Scarinci, Michel Bierlaire, and Nikolaos Geroliminis
18*th Swiss Transport Research Conference*

Awards and Honors

Fully Funded Next-Gen Scholar's Symposium, NUS, Singapore	2024
Sustainability Endowment, Imperial College & University College London, Sargent Center	2024
Travel grant, Imperial College & University College London, Sargent Center	2024
Fully Funded Rising Star Workshop, Stanford University, MS&E Department	2023
PhD Paper Award runner-up, Imperial College Business School	2023
President's PhD Scholarship, Imperial College London	2020 – 2024
Graduate Student Fellowship, Imperial College Business School	2019

Presentations

"Optimal Human-in-the-Loop Recommendation under Endogenous Trust and Probabilistic Adherence"
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, US, October 2025

"Bayesian Modeling of Customer Choice and Churn"
- Imperial College Computatioinal Optimization Group Seminar, London, UK, June 2025

"From Markov Chain Choice to Markov Decision Processes: Equivalence, Optimization, and Construction"
- *Invited talks:* COG Seminar Series, Imperial College London; Institute for Intelligent Computing, Shanghai Jiao Tong University

"From Data to Donations: Optimal Fundraising Campaigns for Non-Profit Organizations"

- MSOM Conference, London, UK, June 2025
- MSOM Conference, Minneapolis, MN, July 2024
- Imperial College President's PhD Scholar Symposium, London, UK, May 2024

"Optimal Campaigning for Non-profit Organizations"

- INFORMS Annual Conference, Phoenix, AZ, October 2023
- Rising Star Workshop at MS&E Department, Stanford University, CA, May 2023

"Randomized Assortment Optimization"

- Next-Gen Scholar's Symposium, Singapore, August 2024
- POMS-HK, Hong Kong, China, January 2024
- RMP Section Conference, London, UK, July 2023
- MSOM Conference, Montréal, Canada, June 2023
- London Operations Research PhD Seminar Series, London, UK, June 2023
- INFORMS Annual Conference, Indianapolis, IN, October 2022
- Transatlantic Doctoral Conference, London, UK, May 2022
- ICBS Operations Research PhD Seminars, London, UK, May 2022
- The 63*th* OR Society's Annual Conference, Virtual, June 2021

Professional Activities

Ad-hoc journal referee for *Management Science*, *Operations Research*, *Operations Research Letters*, *Applied Energy*

Ad-hoc conference referee for *NeurIPS*, *ICML*, *ICLR*

Work Experience

Intern, International Renewable Energy Agency, Abu Dhabi, UAE — July - September 2016

Research Assistant, Transport and Mobility Laboratory, Lausanne, Switzerland — 2017 – 2019

Languages

Mandarin (native), English (fluent), French (beginner), Korean (beginner)